UNIT 4: STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESS

PART I: JOB READINESS

TOPIC 5: TIME MANAGEMENT

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand that you can't really manage time; you can only manage yourself and your use of time
- Understand how setting goals, planning, organizing, and prioritizing can help you use your time more efficiently
- Understand different time management personality types

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Create a plan for getting to scheduled appointments, work, and/or school on time
- Learn to plan, organize and prioritize to reach his/her goals

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Opening Activity: 'Things' (from http://www.thingsthegame.com/)

Materials: Categories, pens/pencils, small slips of paper
Possible Categories (Be creative and have fun in creating categories.)

- "Things people could do if they had 25 hour days"
- "Things people do when they are bored (at work)"
- "Things people do to better manage the use of their time"

(remind people to keep their answers work appropriate)

Rules included from http://www.thingsthegame.com/rules.html

Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will explore different time management personality types.
Time: 15 minutes
Materials: Handout: "Time Management Personality Types"

Hand out and read "Time Management Personality Types" as a group. Ask students to identify which personality type BEST describes them. Have people group up by personality type and discuss the greatest challenge for their 'type'. Have them also discuss the best way to address that time management challenge and report back to the larger group.

Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will explore different strategies for better managing their use of time.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Ten Tips for Time Management,"** flip chart paper, markers

Break students into small groups. Ask each group to create a "Top Ten Tips for Time Management" list on flipchart paper. Have students present their lists to the larger group.

Hand out and read **"Ten Tips for Time Management"** as a group. Discuss the similarities among all of the lists. Which tips seem most useful? Which tips would be most difficult to follow? Why?

Discuss the importance of time management at work. Ask for at least one example of how each tip could be applied at work.

Writing/Reflection/Activity

Objective: Students will understand the importance of being responsible for being on time.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Handout **"Be on Time Checklist,"** pens/pencils

Hand out **"Be on Time Checklist."** Ask students to think of something that they have to do in the next two weeks, for which it is important for them to be on time. For example: school, work, interview, training program, court, doctor's appointment, meeting, etc. Ask them to write what they are thinking about on the line and continue to complete the Checklist. When they have finished, discuss the benefits of planning in advance to be on time.

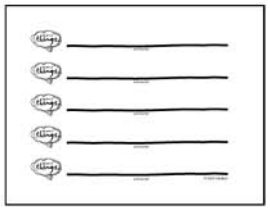
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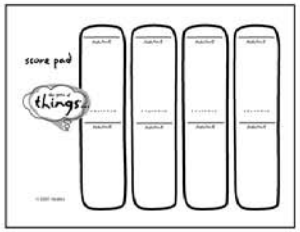
(8 pencils also included)



300 Topic Cards

Answer Pad





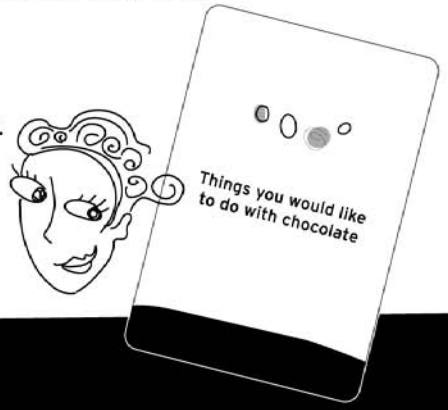
Score Pad

SET UP YOUR GAME LIKE THIS

- Someone keeps score. This player takes the Score Pad.
- Every player gets a pencil and a perforated section from the answer pad.
- Shuffle the cards and place them facedown within reach of all the players.

WHAT YOU DO...

1 Pick a player to be the Reader. This player picks a card and reads it aloud.



WHAT THE READER DOES

- Keeps the game moving...
- Doesn't let people linger too long on their answers...
- Reads all of the responses out loud...
- Re-reads the answers for those with short memories...

2 Everyone (including the Reader) writes an answer on their answer sheet. Fold it twice and give it to the Reader. **IMPORTANT:** There are no correct answers! These are topics not questions. So write whatever you want. Write funny things or write outrageous things!



3 The Reader reads **ALL** the answers out loud.



4 The player to the left of the Reader guesses first. Choose one answer and try to match it to the player who wrote it. **YOU CANNOT GUESS THE READER.** If you're right, the Reader gives the answer sheet back to its writer and that player is out of the round. Now you guess again. If you're wrong, you're still in the round but the chance to guess passes to the player on your left. **THE READER DOESN'T GUESS.** You remain in the round until someone matches you up with your response.

5 **THE ROUND ENDS** when only one player **(BESIDES THE READER)** has not been matched to his/her answer. The person to the left of the last Reader now becomes the new Reader. **THE GAME ENDS** when every player has been the Reader.

Time Management Personality Types

Are You Sabotaging Your Time Management Efforts?

By Susan Ward, About.com Guide

The key to time management is knowing ourselves, as we can't actually "manage" time; all we can manage is our own behavior.

For many of us, this is more than enough of a challenge. While we claim that effective time management is a top priority and that we just have to get more organized, our actions don't match our stated desires. I've invented these time management personality "types" to describe patterns of behavior that sabotage many people's attempts at time management.

Which of the following time management "types" are you? While intended as fun, this time management exercise may provide you with some clues for more effective time management.

The Fireman – For you, every event is a crisis. You're so busy putting out fires that you have no time to deal with anything else — especially the boring, mundane things such as time management. Tasks pile up around you while you rush from fire to fire all day.

Typically seen — Running to car.

The Over-Committer – Your problem is you can't say 'No'. All anyone has to do is ask, and you'll chair another committee, take on another project, or organize yet another community event. You're so busy you don't even have time to write down all the things you do!

Typically seen — Hiding in rest room.

The Aquarian – There is such as thing as being too "laid-back" — especially when it starts interfering with your ability to finish tasks or bother to return phone calls. Getting to things when you get to them isn't time management; it's simple task avoidance.

Typically seen — Hanging out with feet on desk.

The Chatty Kathy – Born to socialize, you have astounding oral communication skills and can't resist exercising them at every opportunity. Every interaction becomes a long drawn out conversation — especially if there's an unpleasant task dawning that you'd like to put off.

Typically seen — Talking on cell phone.

The Perfectionist – You have a compulsion to cross all the "t's" and dot all the "i's," preferably with elaborate whorls and curlicues. Exactitude is your watchword, and you feel that no rushed job can be a good job. Finishing tasks to your satisfaction is such a problem, you need more time zones, not just more time.

Typically seen — Hunched over latest project.

Hopefully none of these time management personality profiles is a photograph of you! But perhaps these descriptions will provoke some thought about the different ways we manage or mismanage time, and some clues about how we might change our behaviors to make our time management efforts more successful.

From http://sbinfocanada.about.com/cs/timemanagement/a/timetypes.htm April 14, 2010

Ten Tips of Time Management

1. **Make a to do list, and then prioritize your list. Don't prioritize your schedule, schedule your priorities.**

2. **Dare to break the to do list. Be flexible as things change. Adjust your list as needed; the list is just a guide to help you use your time more efficiently.**

3. **Don't wait until things become urgent. Take care of things when you have time. Figure out a way to avoid living crisis to crisis.**

4. **Focus on your goals. Use your time to work towards your goals.**

5. **Identify where you waste time and figure out how you can spend that time more efficiently.**

6. **Know when to quit. If something is not working, don't be afraid to make a new plan.**

7. **Don't waste time holding on to or worrying about things you can't change. Use your time to change what you can.**

8. **Learn to be okay with the outcome if you delegate. Choose carefully who you delegate to, and check in to make sure progress is being made and the work is getting done, but understand that not everyone will do things the way you would do it.**

9. **Learn to say 'no'.**

10. **Take time for you. You can't work efficiently if you are not taking care of yourself.**

Adapted from http://www.alltipsandtricks.com/all-for-time-and-time-for-all-the-10-commandments-of-time-management/ April 14, 2010

Be Responsible for Being On Time Checklist

Think of something that it is important for you to be on time for in the next two weeks. Write it on the line:

_____

Things I need to do before leaving home:

- ____ Eat
- ____ Shower/bath
- ____ Brush teeth/floss/use mouthwash
- ____ Hair
- ____ Make-up
- ____ Iron
- ____ Get dressed
- ____ Assist other people (younger sibling, grandmother, dad, etc.)
- ____ Chores (wash dishes, make bed, take out garbage, etc.)
- ____ Get everything together that I need

This will all take approximately _____ minutes

I know where to go.

- ____ Yes
- ____ No — How am I going to find out? _____

I am getting there by:

- ____ Car (Consider traffic and whether your car has gas.)
- ____ Bus/Subway (Get to the bus stop early, and take a bus that is scheduled to arrive to your destination with extra time to spare.)
- ____ Taxi (Make sure the taxi will be there with enough time to get to your destination early and that you have enough money to pay for the trip.)
- ____ Another person is driving, (Make sure the person driving you is responsible and will get you where you need to be on time, if not early.)
- ____ Walking (Have you walked there before? How long did it take?)

Transportation will take approximately _____ minutes.

Total time it will take for me to get ready and travel there: _____

Time I need to be there: _____

I will need to leave by: _____

Add an extra 10-15 minutes to your estimated time to allow for unexpected circumstances (weather, accidents, something at home, bus running late, etc.)

Adapted from **http://www.workshopsinc.com/manual/Ch3H1.html** April 14, 2010